Moodle

Study Assistant

Tutorial

A beginner's tutorial for Windows • ChatGPT / Codex and DeepSeek Harness

No coding experience needed. Create a separate folder, ask AI to read the project link and install the tools, then connect your own school account. After that, study through chat.

This workflow is your personal course workspace. It organizes materials, reads Moodle requirements, explains topics, gives practice and saves progress. Most daily tasks use plain-language requests.

Which edition?

Author's recommendation: if you already subscribe to ChatGPT Pro, choose the Codex edition. Other students should start with the DeepSeek Harness edition.

From setup to studying

01 **Install an AI app**

Choose ChatGPT desktop or DeepSeek Harness. See page 2.

02 **Create a separate workspace**

Open a new, empty folder as your local project. See pages 3–4.

03 **Give AI the project link**

Send one setup prompt; add missing dependencies if needed. See pages 5–7.

04 **Sign in and select courses**

Sign in on your school's website, then choose courses and sync mode. See pages 8–9.

05 **Study and get support**

Learn, revise and save progress; report problems on GitHub. See pages 10–13.

Before you start: a Windows computer, internet access, an AI app account and your own school Moodle account. The project is open source; AI access, usage limits and fees are set by the service provider.

Install one AI app

Author's recommendation: if you already subscribe to ChatGPT Pro, choose the Codex edition. Other students should start with the DeepSeek Harness edition. If your app already works, go to page 3.

Route A / ChatGPT desktop + Codex

Open the official ChatGPT Windows installation guide

1. Follow the official guide's ChatGPT desktop app link to the Windows download or store page and install it.
2. Open the app and sign in to your ChatGPT account.
3. Select Codex from the ChatGPT dropdown, then set Work in to This computer. This tutorial requires local file access and the ability to run installation commands.

If Codex or the local-computer option is missing, check app updates, account permissions and the official getting-started guide. Pasting a link into a regular web chat does not prove the project is installed on your computer.

Route B / DeepSeek Harness desktop

Open the official DeepSeek Harness website

1. Choose the desktop download and Windows (64-bit).
2. Open the downloaded installer and follow its instructions.
3. Use the sign-in flow provided by the app. Signing in to the AI app does not connect school Moodle.
4. Set up the workspace on pages 3–4, then send "Hello" to check that the app can reply before installing the project.

Choose the matching branch

ChatGPT / Codex uses the codex branch.
DeepSeek Harness uses the deepseek branch.
A branch is a version of the same project prepared for a particular client.

If chat is unavailable, no model is available or you hit a usage limit, check the app's account and usage pages first. This tutorial does not require a separate API key purchase. If you only see key settings, check official sign-in instructions; never enter your school password there. Open-source code does not make model services free.

Create a separate workspace

A workspace is a dedicated folder for the assistant and your study materials.

Step 1 / Create an empty folder

In Windows File Explorer, choose a permanent location, then right-click → New → Folder. Name it MoodleStudy. You can use Documents, or D:\MoodleStudy if your computer has a D: drive.

Do not select your entire Desktop, an entire drive or a folder used by another project. To try both clients, use separate folders named MoodleStudy-Codex and MoodleStudy-DeepSeek.

Step 2 / Open it in the AI app

ChatGPT / Codex: find Projects in the left sidebar and click the + on that row. Name the project MoodleStudy and follow the prompts to select or associate the local folder. Use Codex in that project with This computer selected.

DeepSeek Harness: click the folder-plus button beside Workspace in the left sidebar. Select MoodleStudy, confirm, then start a chat in that workspace. The next page shows both entry points.

Not sure whether you opened the right folder?

Please check that this chat can read and write my selected MoodleStudy folder and run local commands. Tell me the current workspace path. If this is only a regular chat, help me open the correct local project.

Step 3 / Start setup in this chat

For ChatGPT / Codex, copy the complete prompt on page 5. For DeepSeek Harness, use page 6. Choose only your route; do not combine or send both prompts.

Ready: the folder appears in the project/workspace list and AI reports the same local path. If AI installs into a subfolder, reopen the final path it gives you. After setup, that folder should directly contain README.md, AGENTS.md and start.cmd.

Find the workspace entry point

Actual Windows app screenshots. They use Chinese labels; translations appear below. Layouts may change.

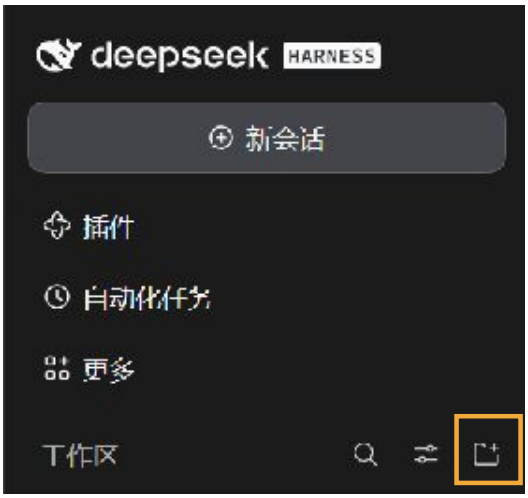
A / ChatGPT: the + beside Projects



1. Find 项目 (Projects) in the left sidebar.
2. Click the + on that row, highlighted in the screenshot.
3. Create MoodleStudy, select or associate the local folder from page 3, then start your chat inside the project.

The author supplied this screenshot. The highlighted + belongs to Projects; it is not the attachment button beside the chat input.

B / DeepSeek Harness: the workspace +



1. Find 工作区 (Workspace).

2. Click the folder-plus icon at the right, highlighted here.

3. Select MoodleStudy, then 选择文件夹 (Select Folder). Start a new chat in that workspace.

What should success look like?

Your chosen folder appears in the project/workspace list. Enter it before chatting. Do not use the whole Documents folder, or send setup instructions from a regular chat with no project selected.

If the selected folder differs from the path AI reports, resolve that first. These screenshots show the entry points; they do not mean your project has already been created or installed.

ChatGPT / Codex setup prompt

Copy all the text inside the shaded area. If you chose the other route, skip this page.

Route A / Send this complete prompt once

I use ChatGPT desktop with Codex in local mode. Read this project URL and install its codex branch: https://github.com/jiangzengyuang-jisoo/moodle-study-assistant/tree/codex

I am a beginner. Please install the project for me and teach me how to use it.

First read that branch's README, AGENTS.md, setup and chat-onboarding instructions. Download the correct version into this separate workspace. Preserve existing files and study records; never replace them with a blank profile.

Check bundled runtimes and dependencies. If Node.js (22+) or Python (3.11+) is missing, install a project-compatible version from an official source. If I must act, give me the exact version, official download link, file type and next button.

Actually run setup and verify the tools work. Explain the current status whenever I need to approve, sign in, restart or reopen a folder. Report the final full project path.

Confirm my school's Moodle homepage before opening browser sign-in. I will enter credentials and verification codes only on the appropriate official or school website. Do not ask for them in chat or read credential files or browser cookies.

List courses in chat and let me choose courses and Full initialization or Information only. Read course requirements, report missing or failed items, and ask about my real progress and available time.

Show me how to study and check my course list, material page references, saved progress and continuity in a new chat. Do not submit assignments, answer school quizzes, post or send email for me.

Select the shaded text with your mouse and press Ctrl+C. Return to the matching workspace chat, press Ctrl+V, check the URL and branch, then send.

If AI cannot open the URL: open it yourself, check the branch, choose Code → Download ZIP, then right-click the ZIP → Extract All. Open the folder containing README.md, AGENTS.md and start.cmd as your workspace and ask AI to continue from the local instructions.

DeepSeek Harness setup prompt

Copy all the text inside the shaded area. If you chose the other route, skip this page.

Route B / Send this complete prompt once

I use DeepSeek Harness desktop. Read this project URL and install its deepseek branch: https://github.com/jiangzengyuang-jisoo/moodle-study-assistant/tree/deepseek

I am a beginner. Please install the project for me and teach me how to use it.

First read that branch's README, AGENTS.md, setup and chat-onboarding instructions. Download the correct version into this separate workspace. Preserve existing files and study records; never replace them with a blank profile.

Check bundled runtimes and dependencies. If Node.js (22+) or Python (3.11+) is missing, install a project-compatible version from an official source. If I must act, give me the exact version, official download link, file type and next button.

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Let AI check missing dependencies

Use this page only if AI reports a missing runtime and cannot install it automatically. Otherwise, go to page 8.

Check before installing

The setup prompt already asks AI to check the environment. Your client may include usable runtimes, so do not install duplicates just to complete a list. If something is missing, ask AI to install it from the official source and explain any required installer or permission prompt.

If you must install manually

Official Node.js download

Ask AI for the compatible version and your computer's architecture. Choose a Windows LTS release, version 22 or newer, and download the Windows Installer (.msi). Open it and follow Next → Install, retaining the default npm component. Do not choose a source archive.

Official Python downloads for Windows

Ask AI for a compatible stable release, version 3.11 or newer. For a traditional installer, choose Windows installer (.exe), not the embeddable package. If Add Python to PATH appears, select it before Install Now. If the website directs you to Python install manager, follow that official flow for the specified version.

Ask this if the download choices are confusing

> Tell me the exact version, whether I need x64 or ARM64, and the official installer link. After I install it, check that Node.js, Python and the project tools actually run. Preserve my records and continue setup.

When should you restart?

After installing runtimes, or when AI asks you to reload tools, save your progress, quit and reopen the client, return to the same workspace and say "Continue setup." DeepSeek Harness's × may only hide its window; use Exit in the app or system tray menu.

Success means AI reports an actual runtime check and confirms the local tools work. "Files downloaded" or "Configuration generated" alone does not establish a working installation.

Browser sign-in: enter details yourself

This connects your school Moodle account. It is separate from signing in to the AI app.

Complete sign-in in order

1. Give AI your school name and official Moodle homepage. HKU example: https://moodle.hku.hk/. Use your own school's URL. Do not supply a /course/view.php course link or a URL containing long sign-in parameters.

2. Ask AI to start the connection and wait for the school sign-in page. The helper usually uses Edge; Chrome may be supported.

3. Enter your credentials on the school website yourself. Complete verification codes, two-factor authentication and school confirmations.

4. Return to the chat and let AI verify the connection and list your available courses.

Page keeps spinning? Try one refresh

If you have submitted all personal details but the webpage keeps spinning, refresh that page once using its refresh button or F5. Check whether it continues. Refresh only the stuck webpage; do not end the installation task waiting for your sign-in.

First identify whether the stuck page belongs to AI-app sign-in or school Moodle. App sign-in should return you to a working chat; Moodle still needs a verified school connection. This is an author-provided troubleshooting tip, not a guaranteed fix for every sign-in failure.

How do you know it connected?

Look for confirmation that the school API connection is verified and your course list can be read. A school homepage or a stopped spinner alone does not establish a working tool connection.

After completing school sign-in

I have finished signing in on the school website. Please verify the connection and list courses for me to choose. If it failed, tell me exactly where it stopped.

Never paste passwords, verification codes or tokens into chat or GitHub. Moodle permissions differ by school, and browser-assisted sign-in has compatibility limits. Ask AI to troubleshoot using the project instructions instead of repeatedly reinstalling everything.

Select courses and initialize

Choose courses and a preparation mode in chat. You do not need to memorize numeric IDs.

Choose this semester's courses

Reply with course names from the list AI shows you. If a course has a shared page and a class-specific page, ask AI to explain the difference before you choose. Do not copy another student's course IDs.

Choose how to prepare materials

Full initialization: authorize access to currently available content for your selected courses, download direct files, organize them and build a search index. Later syncs add changes incrementally. Choose this to study with course materials.

Information only: sync course information, assignments and notices without automatically downloading course files. Choose this if you prefer to supply your own materials.

To authorize preparation of course materials

I choose [course names] from your list. Fully initialize these courses: download accessible materials, organize them and build an index. Report what is still missing, then read current assignment requirements, deadlines and relevant notices.

Describe your real situation

Explain which assignments you submitted, which you only completed on paper, and whether a teammate submitted group work. Say where you are in each course, what you find difficult and how much time you have today. Progress should not be guessed.

Begin your first study session

I have 60 minutes today. I have completed [work], reached [topic], and struggle most with [difficulty]. Use the course requirements to plan my first session. Explain one concept, then let me try independently.

Ready means tools work, the school connection is verified, courses and permissions are confirmed, and collected information has been read. Downloaded materials are not necessarily read by AI, and neither downloading nor reading means you have mastered them.

Check four things after setup

Do this after "installation successful." Each success check should be something you can verify yourself.

1 / It can list my courses

Send in the current workspace

List my selected courses. State whether the school connection was verified and which information could not be retrieved this time.

Pass: your courses appear. Resolve missing courses, the wrong account or a connection failure before continuing.

2 / It can cite a page in my materials

No materials yet? Add your own using page 12

Choose a course file I authorized you to read. Give its filename and page number, then explain one concept on that page. I will open the original to check.

Pass: the explanation matches the same file and page you open. Ask AI to correct missing files or mismatched page references. General web knowledge is not proof it read your materials.

3 / It saves my actual study position

Send after a real explanation

Save the course, material page and next step we actually covered to local records. Tell me where you saved them. I only heard an explanation and did not answer independently; do not record this as mastery.

4 / A new chat can pick up the record

Open a new chat inside the same project/workspace

Read the local study records and tell me the last course, material page and next step. Do not start new content yet.

Pass: the new chat recalls the saved position correctly. Otherwise, check that you opened the same project folder and that the records were actually saved. Once all four checks pass, use the next page for daily study.

How to use it every day

Replace bracketed placeholders such as [course/chapter] with your own course, topic or actual situation before sending.

Different topic? Start a new chat

When switching courses or topics, preferably open a new chat within the same project/workspace. Keep follow-ups on the same problem together. Avoid putting every topic in one chat: context can grow too large or approach its limit. Save progress before switching, then ask the new chat to read local records.

1 / Start with your time and goal

Plan today's study

I have 90 minutes today. Use deadlines, current assignment requirements and my actual progress to prioritize the most important tasks. Leave time for breaks.

2 / Learn from the course materials

Start a topic or resume learning

Start [course/chapter]. Read my progress and verify the materials needed for this chapter. Teach from the basics using my instructor's method and cite page numbers. Then give me a new problem to solve independently; do not show the answer yet.

Example: "Start Microeconomics Chapter 3. Explain supply and demand using my instructor's slides." If stuck, say: "I do not understand this step. Please use a simpler example."

3 / Revise: try before seeing the solution

Review and practice

Spend 15 minutes on my recorded weak areas. Give questions first and wait for my answers. Distinguish conceptual, method and calculation errors; plan follow-up review from my actual performance.

4 / Finish by saving actual progress

Send before ending each session

Today I completed [work], spent [minutes], and still struggle with [difficulty]. Save my actual answers, mistakes and next step so I can continue later.

Understanding an explanation, seeing a solution and independently solving a new problem are different states. Say whether you saw an answer or received hints so the record remains useful.

Materials, updates, exams and continuity

Copy only what you need. Replace [course] and [chapter]; for example, use "Microeconomics" as the course.

Add materials and handwritten answers

Inside your project folder, open Study and then _Inbox. Copy your PDF, PPTX or other supported files there. In a chat that supports attachments, you can also provide photos of handwritten answers; name the course and question.

Import your own materials

I added new [course] materials to Study/_Inbox/. Organize them, record their sources and build an index while preserving originals. Then use them to explain [chapter].

Check school updates

Specify the course; explicitly request a full Moodle refresh if needed

Check the latest [course] assignment requirements, deadlines and instructor notices. Distinguish what you verified now from what remains unconfirmed.

The project runs on request. It does not monitor school websites continuously in the background. Scope may differ by branch, so name what you want checked.

Prepare for an exam

Exam revision and practice papers

First verify the instructor's published exam scope and question types. Plan revision using my materials and weak areas. Give practice within the confirmed requirements without answers first. Identify missing materials or unpublished requirements.

Switch topics, chats or days

Stay in the same project; add your course and new goal when changing topics

Read this workspace's study records and resume where I stopped. First tell me the previous sticking point and next step. Do not initialize everything again.

Records mainly live in Study/. Before upgrading, ask AI to back up and preserve records, configuration and material references. Do not delete Study/ to fix problems. Share the public project link with friends, not your entire used workspace.

Report problems on GitHub

An Issue is a feedback report where you can send the project author a problem or suggestion.

First, find out what it is waiting for

Running: downloads or installation are progressing; wait rather than repeating setup.
Waiting for approval: read the requested action in the approval or installer prompt, then decide.
Waiting for sign-in: finish verification in the browser, then return to chat.
Error: give AI the non-sensitive error and ask it to preserve records while troubleshooting.

Ask: "Are you running, waiting for my approval, waiting for sign-in, or stopped with an error? What should I do next?" Missing runtime: page 7. Spinning sign-in page: page 8. After interruption, say "Continue setup" in the original workspace. Do not empty Study/.

Open this project's GitHub Issues

1. Sign in to GitHub, or create an account.
2. Check whether someone has already reported the same problem.
3. Click New issue and use a template if provided.
4. Describe what happened, remove private information and submit. Return to the Issue to read replies.

Copyable issue template

Title: [Codex/DeepSeek] [Problem] during [step]

System: Windows 10/11
Client and version:
Project branch: codex/deepseek; version or download date:
Steps: 1. ⋯ 2. ⋯ 3. ⋯
Expected result:
Actual result / error text:
Already tried: refresh / restart / other
Screenshot: if attached, hide personal information first

Never upload passwords, verification codes, tokens, .private, complete study profiles or private course files. Hide names, student IDs and email addresses in screenshots. AI can draft the report; you review and submit it yourself.

The project reads school information. It does not submit assignments, answer school quizzes, post or email for you, and it cannot bypass interfaces your school does not allow.

Useful links and reference notes

Links checked for the Chinese edition on November 8, 2026. Follow current project and official instructions if interfaces change.

Apps and runtimes

Official ChatGPT Windows installation guide

Codex local-computer mode

DeepSeek Harness website and desktop download

Official Node.js download

Official Python Windows downloads

Project and detailed instructions

Codex project homepage (codex branch)

DeepSeek Harness homepage (deepseek branch)

Detailed Codex beginner guide (Chinese)

DeepSeek chat setup and onboarding (Chinese)

GitHub issue tracker

Scope and limitations

This English adaptation follows the approved Chinese tutorial, based on project instructions, official OpenAI documentation, the DeepSeek Harness website and the author's tips. Each route uses its own branch. The author supplied the ChatGPT project screenshot; the DeepSeek screenshot comes from the local app. A clean-machine installation and real school sign-in were not repeated for this guide.

Compatibility depends on the school's Moodle interfaces and account permissions. Browser-assisted sign-in has experimental limitations. The refresh tip comes from the author; this guide treats it as browser troubleshooting and distinguishes AI-app sign-in from verified school connectivity. It is not assumed to apply to only one website.

Materials and progress are stored locally, but content read by AI may be sent to its model provider. Local storage is not offline use. Check model answers and calculations against the original materials.